Lesson 3

REPENTANCE

Aim: To share the Biblical concept of repentance and to impart the attitude of a repentant heart.

Introduction: *Repentance, like sin, is a common word; yet many of us do not know its actual meaning and implication to our lives. Repentance is a very important foundation in our Christian life and therefore must be learned and applied.*

"The confession of evil works is the first beginning of good works"

I. THE CALL TO REPENTANCE

A. John the Baptist preached it. Matthew 3:2 (trivia: John the Baptist was a cousin of Jesus)

B. Apostles preached it. Acts 2:38, 17-30 *(Peter)*

C. Jesus preached it Mark 1:14-15

II. THE MEANING OF REPENTANCE

1. Greek Meaning – *"metanoeo"*- To have a change of mind. It is a complete turn from one point of view to another. *("metanoia")* It involves the mind, will, action. It is in the action part that we confess. Repentance is a decision, a

result of the process of the mind and will.

2. Biblically - it is a godly sorrow or conviction of sin; a complete desire to turn away from sin or darkness unto God or righteousness. 2 Cor. 7:10

Examples of Godly Sorrow:

1. Peter - Matthew 26:74-75

2. James 4:8-9

3. David - Psalm 6:6

III. WHAT REPENTANCE INVOLVES

A. Confession of Sin - 1 John 1:9 *(When we confess, God is faithful…)*

B. Forsaking of sin - Prov. 28:13, Acts 19:19 *(If we hide our sins, we will not prosper; but if we confess, we will find mercy; forsake right away from sins)*

C. Restitution - Luke 19: 8,9 *(repayment; restoration; compensation-return)*

D. Reconciliation - Mathew 5:23-24 *(being reconciled or reunited with somebody whom you have been estranged from)*

E. Turning from the world - 1 John 2: 15 *(material things are gifts from God; this passage is saying we should not love these and anything the world offers; the world- lust of the eyes, lust of the flesh, pride of life)*

F. Turning from the Devil - Psalm 34:14 *(true repentance involves turning away from evil, doing good, seeking peace, and pursuing it)*

G. Turning from ourselves - 2 Cor. 5:15 *(Is Jesus really Lord over your life? Repentance involves turning away from our own agenda)*

IV. Application

A. Think of sins not yet surrendered to God.

B. Confess, forsake, and ask Gods forgiveness.

C. Begin to live in line with God's Word.